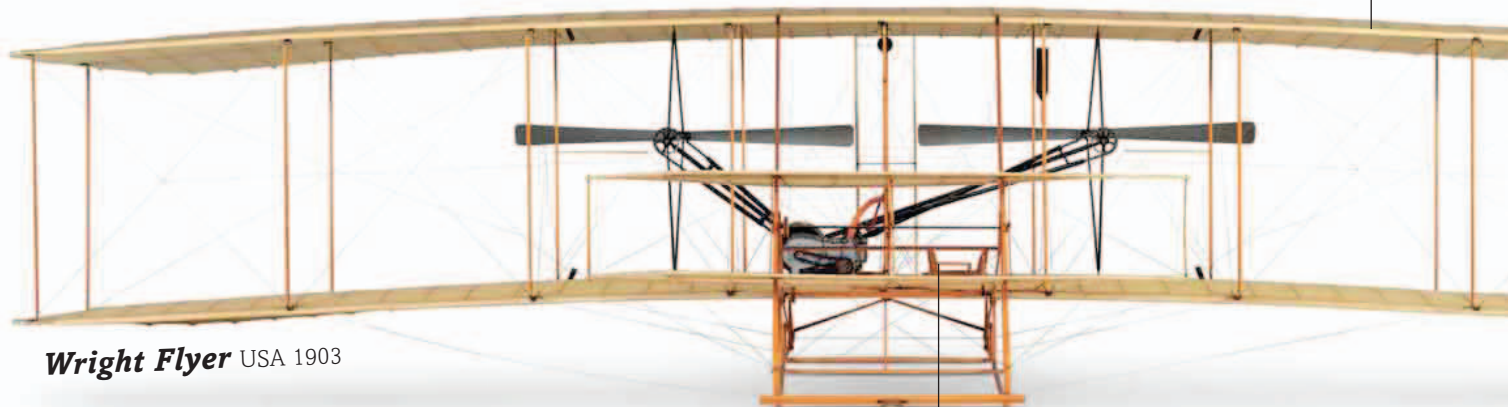




First planes

Wings stretch to 40ft 4 in (12.3 m) and are supported by struts



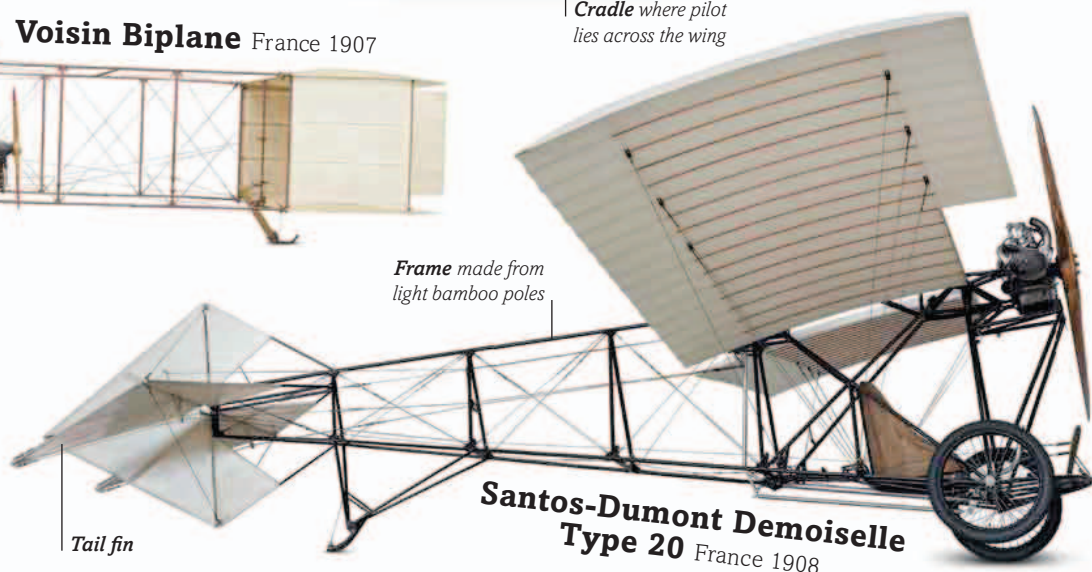
Wright Flyer USA 1903

Cradle where pilot lies across the wing



Voisin Biplane France 1907

Hinged elevator panel controls pitch (climb or dive) by pointing the aircraft's nose upward or downward



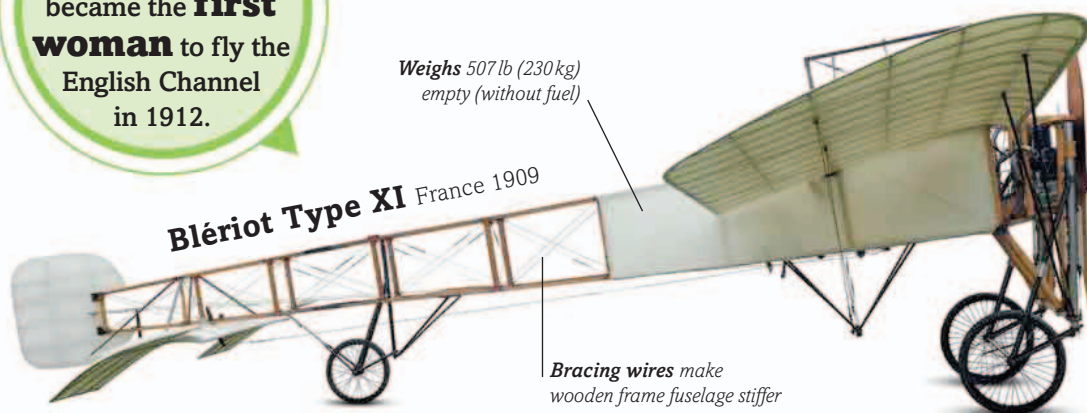
Frame made from light bamboo poles

Tail fin

Santos-Dumont Demoiselle Type 20 France 1908

Harriet Quimby, in a Blériot XI, became the **first woman** to fly the English Channel in 1912.

Weighs 507 lb (230 kg) empty (without fuel)



Blériot Type XI France 1909

Bracing wires make wooden frame fuselage stiffer

On December 17, 1903, bicycle-maker Orville Wright lifted off into the air in a powered aircraft. This first flight lasted only 12 seconds and covered less than the length of a modern airliner, but it marked the beginning of a new age.

Built by two brothers, the **Wright Flyer** was a biplane, with two sets of wings, and two propellers spinning behind them. The **Voisin Biplane** and **Shorts S27** copied this pusher-propeller design, but other aircraft, such as the **Santos-Dumont Demoiselle**, mounted their